DRUM LAB · LEVEL 1 OF 4 · 4/4

Pulse & coordination

Name _____ Date _____ Starting BPM _____

Goal: Keep four equal beats and coordinate hands with a foot. Suggested starting range: 50–65 BPM; slower is fine.

Ready? Clap four steady beats while counting aloud.

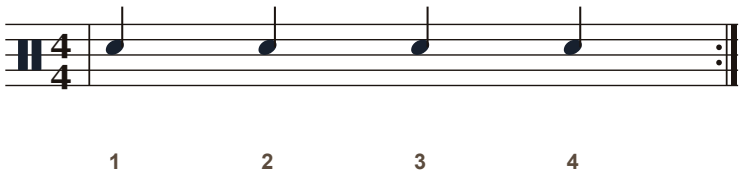
Count one bar in. Speak → tap one part → combine → repeat four bars. After three clean repetitions add 5 BPM; if time slips, slow down.

Count: 1 2 3 4

Key: X = hi-hat; middle note = snare; low note = kick; brackets = quiet ghost note. R/L = right/left hand. Read toms by their staff position.

1. Steady hands

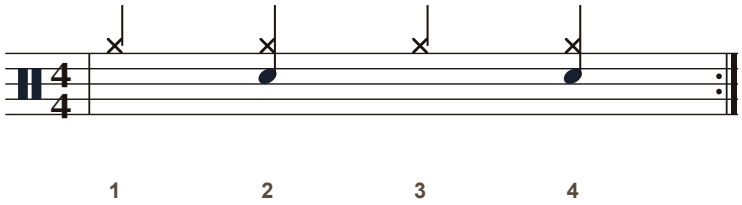
Alternate R L R L. Let the sticks rebound; keep all four strokes even.



Clean repeats: □ □ □ Starting BPM _____ Comfortable BPM _____

2. Find the backbeat

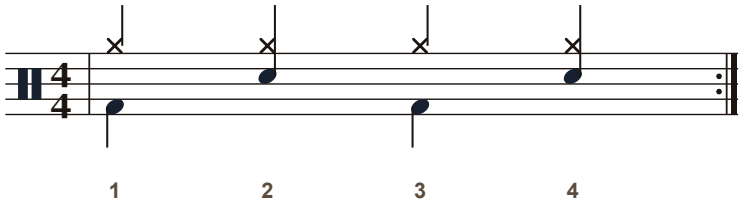
Tap the pulse with one hand. Add the other hand on 2 and 4.



Clean repeats: □ □ □ Starting BPM _____ Comfortable BPM _____

3. Add your foot

Keep the same hands. Add kick on 1 and 3; practice two limbs first if needed.



Clean repeats: □ □ □ Starting BPM _____ Comfortable BPM _____

4. Make it yours

Write a four-beat body-percussion pattern. Use K for foot, S for clap and H for knee tap.

Part	1	e	&	a	2	e	&	a	3	e	&	a	4	e	&	a
Hands																
Feet																

Ready to progress: Play four bars with equal spacing, counting aloud without stopping. □ Not yet □ With help □ Independently

Practice log: Date _____ BPM _____ Focus _____ Next step _____

Listen back: What stayed steady? _____ What will you change? _____

DRUM LAB · LEVEL 2 OF 4 · 4/4

Eighth-note grooves

Name _____ Date _____ Starting BPM _____

Goal: Hold steady eighth notes while changing only the kick. Suggested starting range: 55–80 BPM; slower is fine.

Ready? Play level 1's complete groove for four steady bars.

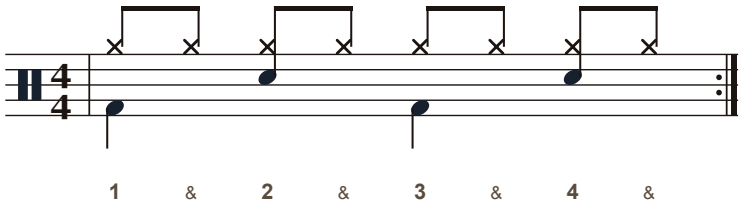
Count one bar in. Speak → tap one part → combine → repeat four bars. After three clean repetitions add 5 BPM; if time slips, slow down.

Count: 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 &

Key: X = hi-hat; middle note = snare; low note = kick; brackets = quiet ghost note. R/L = right/left hand. Read toms by their staff position.

1. Eight even hi-hats

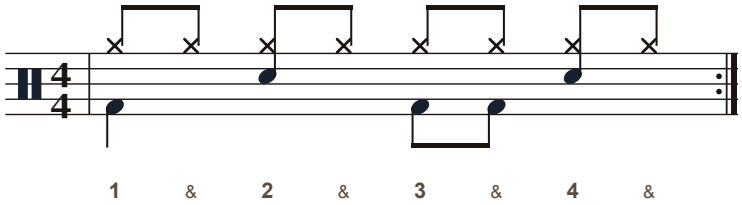
Say every number and &. Keep the hi-hat quieter than the backbeat.



Clean repeats: □ □ □ Starting BPM _____ Comfortable BPM _____

2. An extra kick

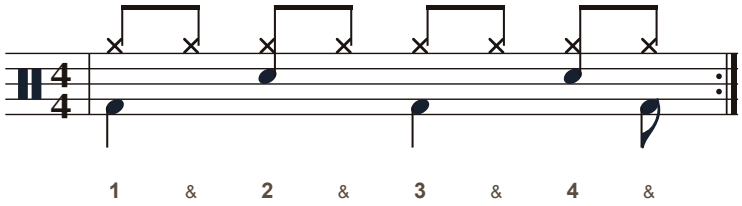
Add kick on the & of 3. Leave every other part unchanged.



Clean repeats: □ □ □ Starting BPM _____ Comfortable BPM _____

3. Lead into the repeat

Move that extra kick to the & of 4. Do not rush the next beat 1.



Clean repeats: □ □ □ Starting BPM _____ Comfortable BPM _____

4. Make it yours

Write an eighth-note groove with snare on 2 and 4. Change one kick and circle it.

Part	1	e	&	a	2	e	&	a	3	e	&	a	4	e	&	a
Hands																
Feet																

Ready to progress: Play each groove four times without losing the eighth-note pulse. □ Not yet □ With help □ Independently

Practice log: Date _____ BPM _____ Focus _____ Next step _____

Listen back: What stayed steady? _____ What will you change? _____

DRUM LAB · LEVEL 3 OF 4 · 4/4

Sixteenths & control

Name _____ Date _____ Starting BPM _____

Goal: Place notes between hi-hat strokes without speeding up. Suggested starting range: 50–75 BPM; slower is fine.

Ready? Keep level 2 steady while speaking its eighth-note counts.

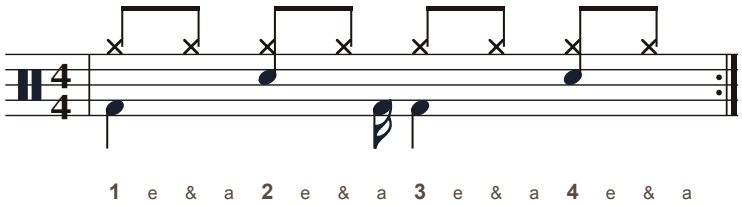
Count one bar in. Speak → tap one part → combine → repeat four bars. After three clean repetitions add 5 BPM; if time slips, slow down.

Count: 1 e & a 2 e & a 3 e & a 4 e & a

Key: X = hi-hat; middle note = snare; low note = kick; brackets = quiet ghost note. R/L = right/left hand. Read toms by their staff position.

1. A sixteenth-note pickup

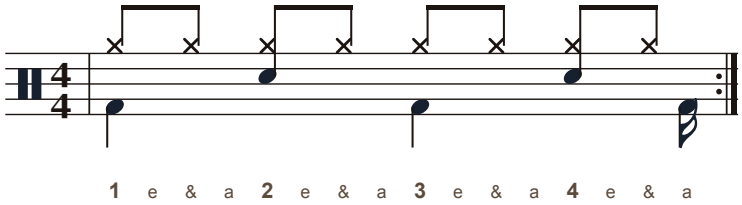
Say 2 e & a. The extra kick is on the a of 2, just before beat 3.



Clean repeats: □ □ □ Starting BPM _____ Comfortable BPM _____

2. Shift the pickup

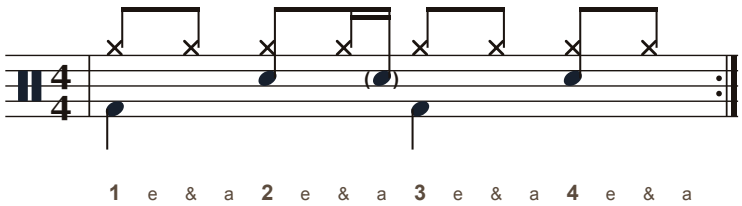
Place the extra kick on the a of 4. Loop slowly across the bar line.



Clean repeats: □ □ □ Starting BPM _____ Comfortable BPM _____

3. Control the quiet stroke

The bracketed snare on the a of 2 is a ghost note: much quieter than 2 and 4.



Clean repeats: □ □ □ Starting BPM _____ Comfortable BPM _____

4. Make it yours

Write one sixteenth-note kick pickup. Label its count; keep the backbeat on 2 and 4.

Part	1	e	&	a	2	e	&	a	3	e	&	a	4	e	&	a
Hands																
Feet																

Ready to progress: Loop four bars with accurate pickups and clearly softer ghost notes. □ Not yet □ With help □ Independently

Practice log: Date _____ BPM _____ Focus _____ Next step _____

Listen back: What stayed steady? _____ What will you change? _____

DRUM LAB · LEVEL 4 OF 4 · 4/4

Musical independence

Name _____ Date _____ Starting BPM _____

Goal: Keep the pulse through changing textures and phrase endings. Suggested starting range: 60–90 BPM; slower is fine.

Ready? Play level 3 slowly with relaxed hands and distinct dynamics.

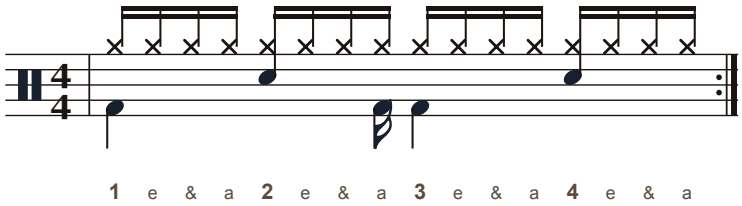
Count one bar in. Speak → tap one part → combine → repeat four bars. After three clean repetitions add 5 BPM; if time slips, slow down.

Count: 1 e & a 2 e & a 3 e & a 4 e & a

Key: X = hi-hat; middle note = snare; low note = kick; brackets = quiet ghost note. R/L = right/left hand. Read toms by their staff position.

1. Continuous sixteenths

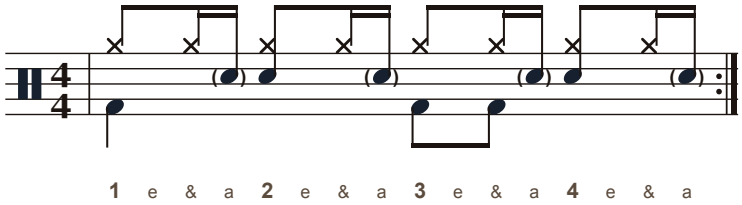
Use one hand on hi-hat at a comfortable tempo. Keep snare accents clear.



Clean repeats: □ □ □ Starting BPM _____ Comfortable BPM _____

2. Ghost-note coordination

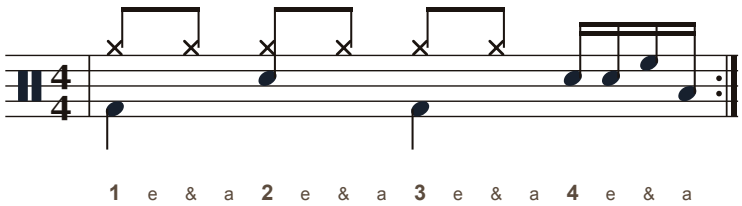
Bracketed snare notes stay low and quiet; the backbeats remain strong.



Clean repeats: □ □ □ Starting BPM _____ Comfortable BPM _____

3. A beat-4 fill

Play three bars of exercise 1, then this bar. Fill R L R L on beat 4; land on kick + crash at the next 1.



Clean repeats: □ □ □ Starting BPM _____ Comfortable BPM _____

4. Make it yours

Design a beat-4 fill. Label hands R/L, then play three groove bars and one fill bar.

Part	1	e	&	a	2	e	&	a	3	e	&	a	4	e	&	a
Hands																
Feet																

Ready to progress: Play two four-bar phrases with a controlled fill and an on-time return to 1. □ Not yet □ With help □ Independently

Practice log: Date _____ BPM _____ Focus _____ Next step _____

Listen back: What stayed steady? _____ What will you change? _____